HELIOVOLTA

Reporting Standards and Style Guide:

Engineering Services

10/11/2023

Guidelines for reporting

Common Misspellings
Heliovolta →**HelioVolta**
Solargrade → **SolarGrade**
Overstriped→**Over-stripped**
Onsite →**On-site**
Crossmated, cross mated → **Cross-mated**
Undertorqued → **Under-torqued**
Overtorqued → **Over-torqued**
Backnuts → **Back-nuts**

~~Systematic~~: Done or acting according to a fixed plan or system; methodical
Systemic: Systemic describes what relates to or affects an entire system

Common Punctuation Errors
kWDC, KWDC, kWdc, kW $_{DC}$ → **kW$_{DC}$**
kWAC, KWAC, kWac, kW $_{AC}$ → **kW$_{AC}$**

- In SolarGrade, for now, use kWac or kWdc.

Capitalize proper nouns: Combiner Box 3, Inverter 2, Transformer 1, etc.
Capitalize Issue Descriptions: Improper Installation

Add a space in between a number and the unit 50kW$_{AC}$ → 50 kW$_{AC}$

- Except for percentages and dollar signs → 50% or $50

Common Grammar Errors
Boxes→ enclosures. (i.e., monitoring box, electrical box. Junction box or pull box OK)

- Use **Active Voice**, avoid passive voice when possible. The active voice lends itself to confidence in our reports as well.
    - The thermal event was caused by a connector → **A connector caused the thermal event.**

General writing best practices

- Be concise, less is sometimes more.
- Always keep in mind your work may be reviewed by lawyers.
- Use softer language more often.
- Avoid contractions: don't → do not
- Do not use the first or second person: I / we or you found… → HelioVolta found…
- Avoid colloquialisms and idioms: resting on the shoulders of giants → based on prior work

Phrases to generally describe quantities when you didn't measure everything

Systemic: The whole site.
A high percentage: Most or all the sample inspected, but not confirmed to be 100%.
A low percentage: Consistent issues found, but not in large quantities.
Isolated instances: A few locations where the issue occurred.

Executive Summary Best Practices

- The executive summary should highlight major issues, systemic issues, and generally be 1-2 minute summary of the inspection.
- The executive summary should be written so a non-technical account manager or lawyer can read it and understand what is going on with the site.
- The Executive summary should focus on the most important critical/major/systemic issues first.

Structuring Executive Summaries in SolarGrade:

- First paragraph details who was on-site, general scope of work/why were you there, any critical or major severity findings, and any immediate actions needed.
- Additional paragraphs should have a line break between them and should segment the SOW as you see fit. For example, the second paragraph could detail work on the ground and the third could detail work on the roof.
- Final paragraph should read something like:
    - For more details and findings see the full SolarGrade report. Minor and negligible findings should be addressed as part of ongoing operations and maintenance work.

Structure of an Issue Description

Keep it concise, ideally 3 sentences.

- What did we find?
- Why is it important?
- What should be done about it?

SEVERITY DEFINITION

Negligible	Issue found does not present a risk to personnel or site safety. Consider creating a task to remedy on next scheduled O&M visit
Minor	Issue found does not present an immediate risk to personnel or site safety. Create a task to remedy on next scheduled O&M visit.
Major	Issue found presents a risk to personnel or site safety. Dispatch technician to remedy issue as soon as possible.
Critical	Issue found presents an immediate risk to personnel or site safety. De-energize system, notify appropriate personnel and pursue corrective actions immediately.

SolarGrade Report Checklist

Step		Check?
1	Project name matches name on drawings or customer provided.	
2	Layout is attached and referenced correctly.	
3	Report uses HelioVolta Standard report format.	
4	All issues have locations and are georeferenced accurately.	
5	Weather screenshot is cropped correctly.	
6	Issue severity rating is consistent throughout the report.	
7	All issues have descriptions.	
8	Interior issues left unchecked if enclosure not opened.	
9	Any FLIR photos referenced have been added.	
10	No blurry, sideways, or duplicate photos.	
11	Issue descriptions are specific enough for anyone to tell the issue.	
12	Any issues from category duplicates are cleared or verified.	
13	Photo notations are clear and concise.	
14	Executive summary highlights any systemic and/or major issues	
15	No misspelled words or titles	

Reports should be checked for all of the above items before sending out to review.

Version	Date	Author	Notes
1	7/26/23	T.Cemo	
2	8/9/23	J.Nagel	Avoid: idioms, first and second person, contractions
3	10/11/23	T. Cemo	Added SG report Checklist